LESSON 5.3 | Lesson notes

A Security Checklist

Overview

Before releasing an application, go through a checklist. Are all passwords hashed with a slow salted function? Are all database queries parameterised? Is every page served over HTTPS with secure cookies? Is user input validated and output encoded? Do accounts have only the permissions they need? Are secrets kept out of the source code and version control? Are the libraries up to date? Is there a tested backup and a plan for what to do after an incident? Repeat the checklist whenever the application changes.

Key points

- Part of: Securing an Application
- About 20 minutes
- Try the example yourself, then check it

How to use this handout

1. Read the overview first, then work through the key points in order.
2. Write down anything you are unsure about and ask in the course forum.
3. Use page 2 to plan your practice and keep notes.

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Practice checklist

- [ ] Read: A Security Checklist
- [ ] Try the example from the lesson
- [ ] Explain the main idea in your own words
- [ ] Answer the related questions
- [ ] Ask about anything unclear in the forum

My notes